would you love me more if i killed someone for you?

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/56100097.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warnings:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence, Major Character Death

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Other

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra) - background

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra) - mentioned

Additional Tags:
Shadow Weaver's A+ Parenting, Murder, Blood and Gore, Angst, i'm sorry if this caused you pain, it caused me catharsis, Alternate Universe - Canon Divergence

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by cassie_inasky_fullofstars

Summary

In order to "cope" with trauma, Catra takes extremely drastic action.

It's not fatal for her.

Notes

This happened because I read a Catradora ice skating AU and felt extreme rage towards Shadow Weaver for... things.

Blame my friend who encouraged me to do this.

See the end of the work for more notes

It would be a lie to say this was the hardest decision Catra ever made. That honor went to breaking off her relationship with Adora and throwing the damn sword down whatever endless pit had been there at the time. She'd never let herself admit it, but she did regret abandoning Adora like that.

It was, however, a decision she wouldn't regret.

Shadow Weaver was in the Horde's clutches. She was helpless without her connection to the Black Garnet.

And Catra's revenge had been a long time coming. Did the old witch really expect no retaliation from her former wards? Sure, Adora would be in favor of giving her a second chance, but she wasn't there, and Shadow Weaver had always been better at manipulating her than Catra.

The dagger was heavy in her hand. The burden she was allowing herself to bear was even heavier.

If she did this – managed to kill the woman who had made her life hell for years – could she leave and find Adora? Would she still be waiting with open arms like she'd sworn she would all those years ago?

Catra braced herself for what she was about to do. She'd spiked Shadow Weaver's food with tetrodotoxin, and if the old witch knew what she had to do to get a lethal dose of it in the first place, she'd make some comment about just how much Catra cared about her.

She didn't care about Shadow Weaver. At least that was what she told herself as she slid the dagger into her makeshift holster and opened the door to the cell.

Of course Shadow Weaver was staring right at her when she walked in.

Catra almost spilled her plan then and there.

When has she done anything for you?

Her vengeance returned. She barely heard herself say, "Here's your food," with as much bitterness as she could muster.

Now came the waiting part. Tetrodotoxin would only rear its devious head after about twenty minutes after Weaver ate the meal Catra had brought her, and those twenty minutes would raise eyebrows from Hordak if he found out.

A dead body in the prison would have the same effect, but if Catra timed everything perfectly, she'd be out of the Horde by the time anyone noticed that Weaver wasn't breathing.

Catra tried to keep up the idle conversation – she hadn't come here to be told to leave – but her rage was overwhelming, and she wished the damn poison would work a little faster so she could be done with this already.

The first sign of tetrodotoxin poisoning showed up sixteen minutes after Weaver started eating. Hyperventilation. Classic.

She probably thought Catra wouldn't dare try to kill her. Catra wanted to laugh at her more than anything; she'd put up with years of abuse at Shadow Weaver's hands, why did she have any right to suspect that Catra would be nice to her?

The rest of the symptoms followed suit. Tremors. The beginning of paralysis. Lack of motor coordination. Involuntary convulsions.

Shadow Weaver toppled to the ground.

Catra pulled out the dagger, and if Shadow Weaver had eyes underneath that mask, she bet they'd be full of terror.

First aid classes had taught her that the carotids and jugular vein were incredibly important to protect so as to avoid mass blood loss.

They were also easier to access than the heart was. Now that Shadow Weaver was almost fully paralyzed, she couldn't do anything to prevent what Catra was about to do.

She crouched down, dagger poised and ready. The cowl around Weaver's neck was easy to remove and even easier to throw away.

She touched the point of the blade to Weaver's exposed neck, deranged smile coming to her lips.

"I'm doing this for *Adora*," she hissed.

Then she sunk the blade into Weaver's neck, watching the vein burst.

Blood gushed out of her vein, and Catra jumped back to avoid getting soaked with the stuff. She watched as the blood slowed to a trickle and then forced herself to approach Weaver's rapidly dying body for absolute certainty that she was dead.

She pressed the point of the blade to Weaver's carotids and slit them, not bothering with snarky remarks or explanations of her actions.

When she stepped away, confident that Weaver was indeed dead, she turned away and looked down at herself. She was covered in blood; she'd have to change her clothes before she left.

Her hands were free of the blood, but she still wondered if it was there. Would this moment follow her around forever? Would Adora still love her if she was a killer?

Did Adora ever love her in the first place?

Catra shook her doubt from her mind (Weaver was finally gone, thank the goddesses) and made her way to her quarters. After a long shower and a change of wardrobe, she "borrowed" a skiff for a "scouting mission" like Adora had all that time ago.

She should've joined her then. If this was why they made up for lost time, Catra wasn't going to complain.

She cared about Adora too much to give a thought to what other people gave a fuck about.

Catra yelled into the wind as she flew through the night sky. The world seemed unreasonably cruel most days, but now some weight she hadn't known existed had been lifted from her chest, and she was free. Free from Shadow Weaver, free from the Horde, and free to be with Adora.

Her story was just beginning.

End Notes

Is murder ever clean?

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